Jiaozi Recipe

There are hundreds of varieties of *jiaozi* (dumplings) in China, but they are traditionally filled with meat or fish. While *jiaozi* used to be served only on festive occasions, like Chinese New Year and weddings, they are now served throughout the year. They are still considered to be very special, though, symbolizing wealth, fortune and family. Follow this recipe to make some *jiaozi* of your own.

1.5x Dough

Ingredients

Filling

- 1½ cups napa cabbage, cleaned and finely minced
- 1 cup ground pork or beef
- ½ green onion, finely minced
- 4 tbsp bamboo shoots, shredded
- ¼ tsp fresh ginger, finely minced
- 1 garlic clove, cleaned and minced
- 1 tbsp soy sauce
- 1 tsp salt
- 1 tbsp rice wine (or apple cider vinegar)
- ¼ tsp white pepper
- 3 tbsp sesame oil

Dough

- 3 cups all-purpose flour
- 1¼ cups water



Total Time: 60 minutes
Active Time: 20 minutes
Servings: 4-6



Fun Fact: When you eat *jiaozi* during Chinese New Year, some believe you will have good luck in the year to come.

Instructions:

1. Put the flour in a bowl and make a "well" in the center. Gently pour the water into the well, stirring slowly to form a dough.
2. Knead and roll the dough into a ball, adding water if it cracks or feels dry. Cover the dough and set it aside for 30 minutes.
3. In a deep bowl, combine the cabbage with the rest of the filling ingredients. Stir until the filling is well mixed. Set it aside.
4. Separate the dough into three pieces. Using a rolling pin, roll out each piece on a lightly floured surface to ⅛-inch thickness.
5. Using a 2½-inch circle cutter (or the rim of a cup), cut circles out of each piece of dough.
6. Collect the scraps, roll out the dough again and cut additional circles.
7. Working with one circle at a time, place a small amount of filling (about 1 tbsp) in the center of the circle. Fold the dough over the filling, making a half-moon shape. Pinch the edges to seal the dumpling.
8. Bring a large pot of water to a boil, add ¼ tsp salt and drop about half of the dumplings into the pot. Stir the dumplings so they don't stick to the bottom.
9. When the water returns to a boil, add ½ cup of cold water. Bring the water to a boil again and add another ½ cup of cold water. When it returns to a boil again, the dumplings are done!
10. Scoop out the dumplings with a slotted spoon and cook the other half by repeating steps 9 and 10. Serve hot with a mixture of soy sauce and vinegar on the side.

Chinese Inventions:



Panda Pandemonium:



The Great Wall: 7 blue bricks = Some say the Great Wall of China is shaped like a dragon / 10 yellow bricks = Most of the remaining portions of the Great Wall of China are from the Ming Dynasty / 4 red bricks = No, astronauts cannot see the Great Wall of China from space